



MEMORY GAME

How good is your memory? Study the objects on the tray for 45 seconds and try to memorize them. Then close the book, wait one minute, and write down as many objects as you can remember. If you can remember half of the 15 objects, you've done very well. Most people can hold only about seven chunks of information in their short-term memory at a time.



SHORT-TERM MEMORIES

Some memories last only seconds. These short-term memories are made to be forgotten quickly, so they don't clutter your brain. They are held in a kind of mental notepad for a few seconds, in case you need to use them. If the information isn't used, the brain discards it and you forget about it.

WOW!

Our earliest years are impossible to remember since we don't start storing full memories until about three years of age.

LONG-TERM MEMORIES

Some memories can last for years. We call these long-term memories, and they are stored in various parts of the brain, depending on whether they're events, skills, or facts. Some of our clearest long-term memories are those linked to powerful emotions, such as the shock of hearing someone has died or the excitement of going on an exotic vacation.



◀ **EVENTS** *Exciting experiences such as a trip to a theme park have a filmlike, photographic quality, though details are blurred. These memories are stored by the hippocampus and various parts of the outer brain (cortex).*

▶ **SKILLS** *Physical skills such as playing the piano or riding a bicycle are learned by practice and stored in a part of the brain called the cerebellum. Once learned, such skills stay with us for life.*



▶ **FACTS** *Words and facts that we learn are stored in the temporal lobe on the side of the brain. Committing new facts to long-term memory can be difficult. The trick is to keep using them—each time you recall the information, it gets easier to remember.*

